

Building Medical Terms

Word Root

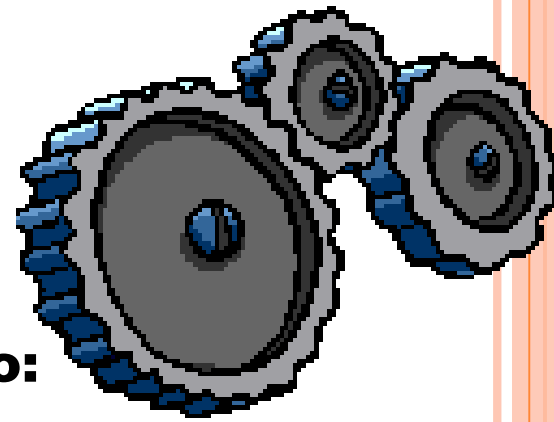
Prefix



Suffi
x

Combining forms

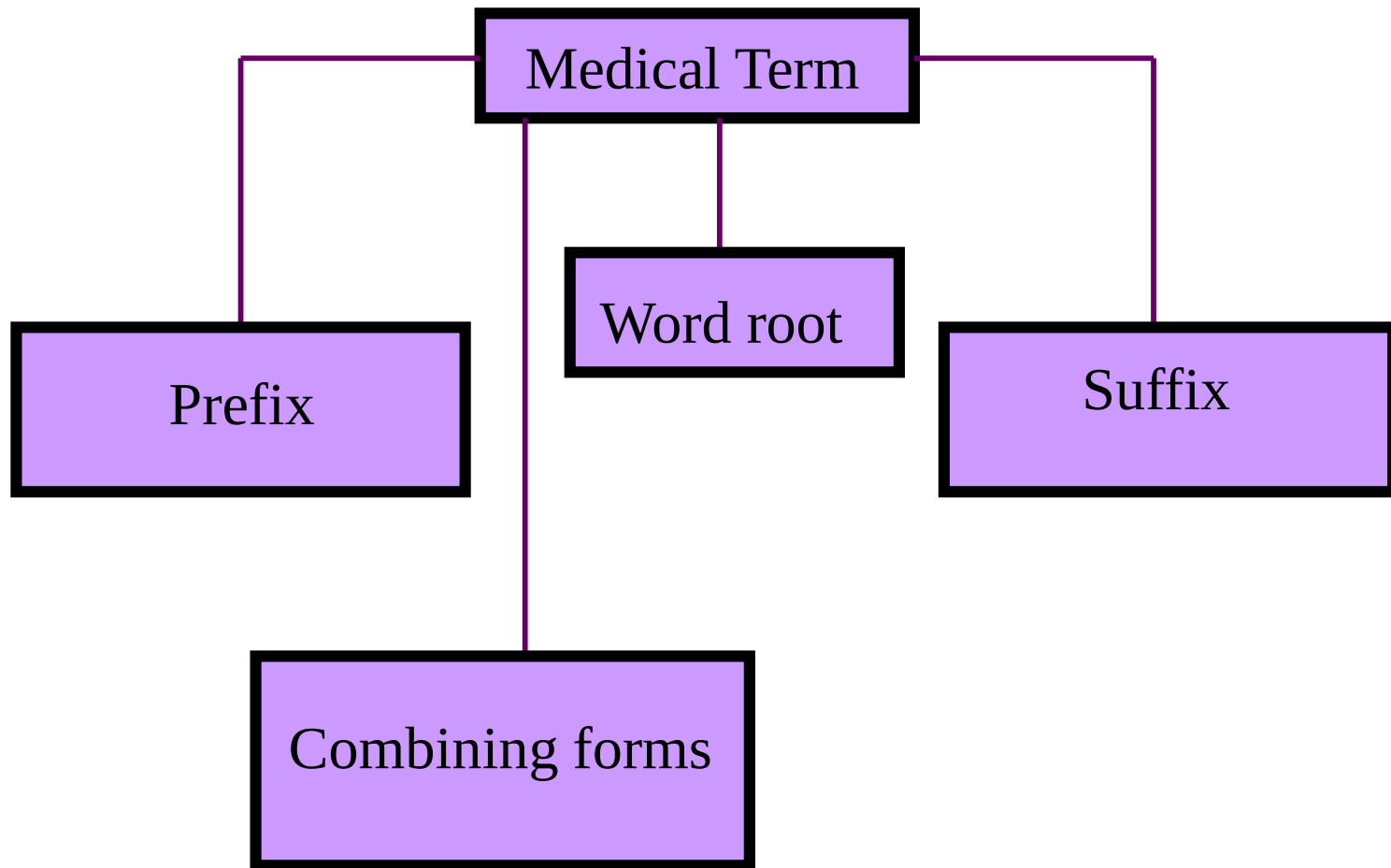
Objectives



After studying this chapter, you will be able to:

- **Define the four word parts used to build medical terms.**
- **Define common medical combining forms.**
- **Define common medical prefixes.**
- **Define common medical suffixes.**
- **Describe how word parts are put together to form words.**

Forming Medical Terms



Forming Medical Terms

Medical terms are formed from two or more word parts.

Word

root

- The main part of a word which contains the basic meaning.

Prefix

- Word parts attached to the beginning of a word that modifies the meaning.

Suffix

- Word parts attached to the end of a word that modifies the meaning.

Combining

- A combining vowel that enable two parts to be connected .

Word Roots and Combining Forms

Combining Forms

Meaning

acanth (o) → **spiny, thorny**

actin (o) → **light**

aer (o) → **air; gas**

athero → **plaque; fatty substance**

bacill (i) → **bacilli; bacteria**

bar (o) → **weight; pressure**

Word Roots and Combining Forms

Combining Forms

Meaning

Blast(o)	→	immature cells
carcin(o)	→	cancer
Chondr(o)	→	cartilage
cry(o)	→	cold
crypt(o)	→	hidden
cyan(o)	→	blue

Word Roots and Combining Forms

Combining Forms

Meaning

cyt(o)



cell

dextr(o)



right

dips(o)



thirst

dors(o)



back

erythr(o)



red

esthesio



**sensation,
perception**

Word Roots and Combining Forms

Combining Forms

Meaning

Galact(o) →

milk

Gluc(o) →

glucose

Ger(o) →

old age

Glyc(o) →

sugars

Gyn(o) →

women

Home(o) →

same

Word Roots and Combining Forms

Combining Forms

Meaning

kinesi(o)

motion

Lact(o)

milk

Leuk(o)

white

Lith(o)

stone

Narco

sleep; numbness

Necro

death; dying

Word Roots and Combining Forms

Combining Forms

Meaning

Noct(i)	→	night
Onc(o)	→	tumor
Path(o)	→	disease
Phag(o)	→	eating
Phon(o)	→	sound; voice
Pseud(o)	→	false
Py(o)	→	pus

Word Roots and Combining Forms

Combining Forms

Meaning

pyro

— . — . — . — . — . — . ▶

fever

salping(o)

— . — . — . — . — . — . ▶

tube

schiz(o)

— . — . — . — . — . — . ▶

split; division

scler(o)

— . — . — . — . — . — . ▶

hardening

scolio

— . — . — . — . — . — . ▶

crooked; bent

somato

— . — . — . — . — . — . ▶

body

spiro

— . — . — . — . — . — . ▶

breath; breathe

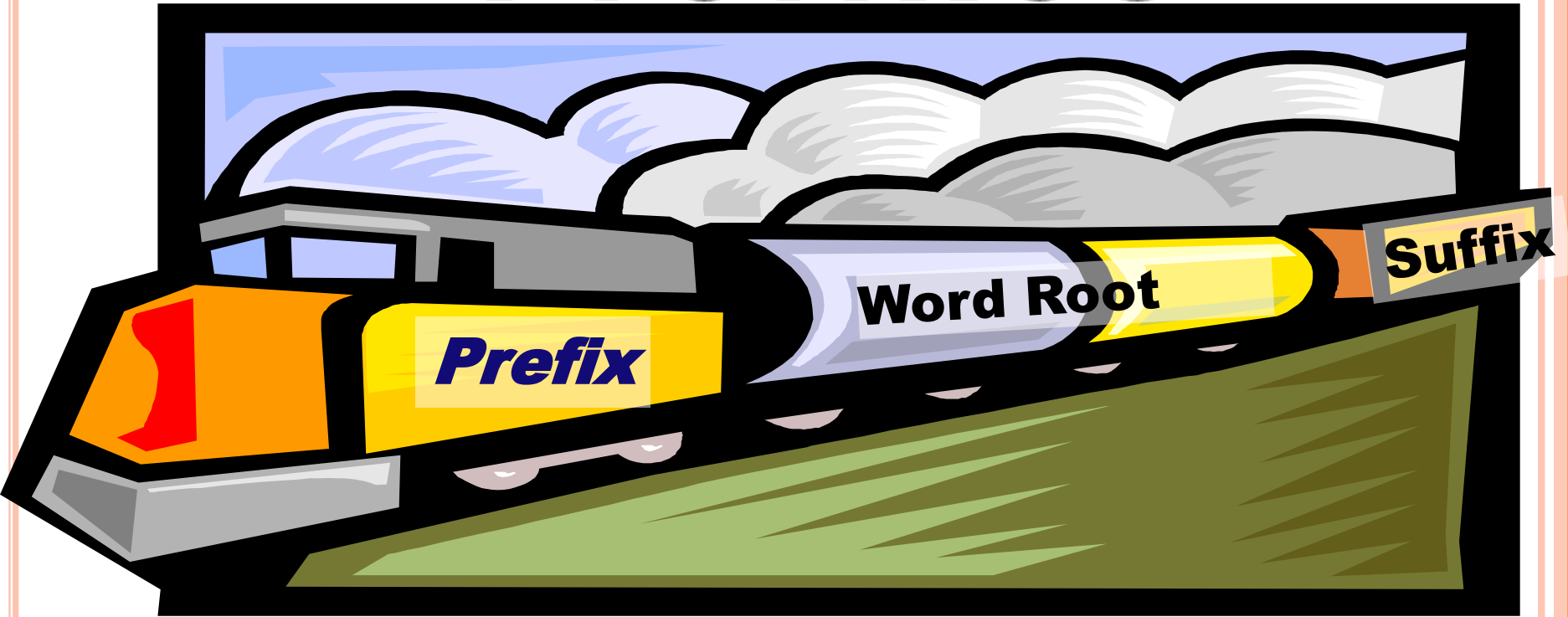
Word Roots and Combining Forms

Combining Forms

Meaning

tono	→	tension; pressure
tropho	→	food; nutrition
xanth(o)	→	yellow
Xer(o)	→	Dry xerophthalmia

Prefixes



- **Prefixes are attached to the beginning of words.**
- **Modifies the meaning of the word or word root.**
- **Indicates size, quantity, position of, and location.**

Prefixes

Prefix

Meaning

a



without

ab



away from

ana



up, toward

ante



before

anti



against

aut(0)



self

Prefixes

Prefix

Meaning

brachy	●—————●	short
brady	●—————●	slow
contra	●—————●	against
dys	●—————●	abnormal; difficult
hemi	●—————●	half
hyper	●—————●	above normal
hypo	●—————●	below normal

Prefixes

Prefix

Meaning

inter		between
iso		equal; same
mal		bad; inadequate
meta		after
micr(o)		small
olig(o)		few; little; scanty
peri		around; about; near

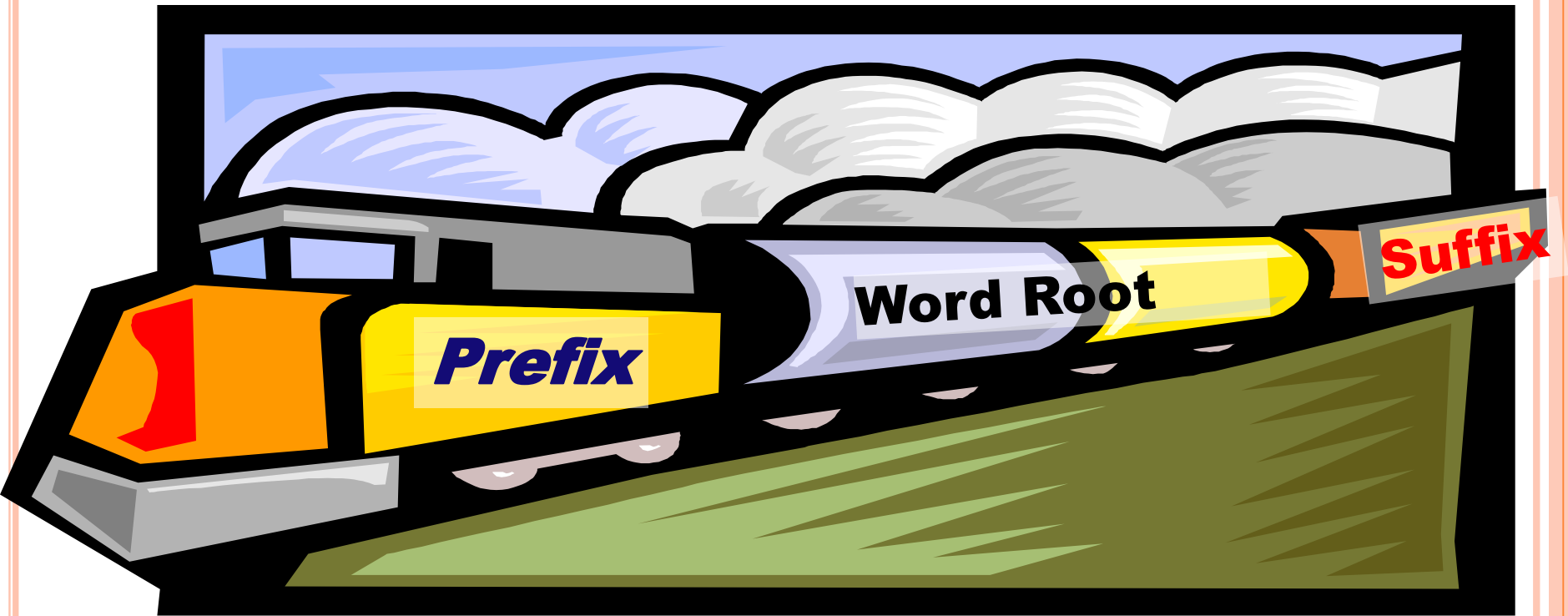
Prefixes

Prefix

Meaning

pro		before; forward
re		again; backward
retro		behind; backward
semi		half
supra		above; over
tachy		fast
un		not

Suffixes



- **Attaches to the end of the word and carries the underlying meaning of the word.**

Suffixes

Suffix

Meaning

-algia	● ————— ●	pain
-asthenia	● ————— ●	weakness
-blast	● ————— ●	immature; forming
-cidal	● ————— ●	destroying; killing
-clast	● ————— ●	breaking
-crine	● ————— ●	secreting

Suffixes

Suffix

Meaning

-crit



separate

-cyte



cell

-cytosis



condition of cells

-derma



skin

-dynia



pain

-ectasis



expanding; dilating

-ectomy



removal of

Suffixes

Suffix		Meaning
-emesis		vomiting
-emia		blood
-esthesia		sensation
-globin		protein
-gram		a recording
-graph		recording instrument
-graphy		process of recording

Suffixes

Suffix

Meaning

-ic	◄—————►	pertaining to
-ism	◄—————►	condition; disease
-itis	◄—————►	inflammation
-kinesia	◄—————►	movement
-logist	◄—————►	one who practices
-lysis	◄—————►	destruction of
-malacia	◄—————►	softening

Suffixes

Suffix

Meaning

-mania



obsession

-megaly



enlargement

-oid



like; resembling

-opia



vision

-ostomy



opening

-para



bearing

-pathy



disease

Suffixes

Suffix

Meaning

-penia	→	deficiency
-pepsia	→	digestion
-pexy	→	fixation
-phage	→	eating; devouring
-phobia	→	fear
-phonia	→	sound
-phrenia	→	of the mind

Suffixes

Suffix

Meaning

-phylaxis	→	protection
-plasty	→	surgical repair
-plegia	→	paralysis
-pnea	→	breath
-ptosis	→	falling down; drooping
-rrhagia	→	heavy discharge
-rrhaphy	→	surgical suturing

Suffixes

Suffix

Meaning

-rrhexis		rupture
-spasm		contraction
-stasis		stopping; constant
-stenosis		narrowing
-tomy		cutting operation
-trophy		nutrition
-tropia		turning

Apply Your Knowledge

Using various word parts, build terms for the following meanings.

Meaning

- Absence of blood
- Bluish color of hands and feet
- Fast heart.
- Breakdown of sugar.

Term

anemia

cyanosis

tachycardia

glycolysis

Apply Your Knowledge

Using various word parts, build terms for the following meanings.

Meaning

- Decrease number of white blood cells.
- Softening of bone.
- Inflammation of a vein.
- Nerve pain.
- Science of skin and its diseases.

Term

leukopenia

osteomalacia

phlebitis

neuralgia

dermatology

THANK YOU